



2-8-2022 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RfmL2f11sjo
Publication Date	2022-02-09T10:39:24Z
Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report: Muncie Community Schools Board of Trustees

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order in the evening (noted as transitioning from afternoon to evening) by the presiding officer. Opening ceremonies included a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Dr. O'Neill, Mr. Heater, Mr. Urban, Mr. Webb (plus additional board members whose names were partially captured or implied during roll call, such as Dr. Kwiatkowski presenting to the board).
 - **Absent / Excused:** Mr. Moore (noted as unwell; Longfellow agenda items postponed), Gary (noted as ill).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Jim (Board President/Chair).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with a moment of silence followed by the Pledge of Allegiance led by the presiding officer.

- **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes from the January 25th meeting were presented as part of the consent agenda and approved by voice vote.
 - **Agenda Adjustments:** The agenda was adjusted to postpone Longfellow items due to Mr. Moore's absence.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:10:32 Superintendent / Staff Updates & Reports

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Kwiatkowski (Superintendent) and staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - Recognized Chuck and Rhonda Reynolds for their recent citizen recognition award by the City-County Council, praising Chuck's long-standing commitment to Muncie.
 - Highlighted a newly developed student mental health resource guide created by counselors, accessible via the district website under students and parents.
 - Introduced an "Ideas and Concerns" online feedback form for students and parents to share feedback.
 - Noted that Julie Snyder oversees the student advisory council and a new feedback loop integrated into the Schoology learning management system.
 - Explained recent e-learning days (Wednesday through Friday) due to weather uncertainty and staff/substitute shortages stemming from surrounding district closures.
 - Announced upcoming kindergarten and pre-k enrollment dates for April 14th at the field house.
 - Celebrated the recent Black History celebration organized by Rhonda Ward, highlighting student essay winners and recognizing community member Jim Williams.
 - Referenced a Purdue University study on the "On My Way Pre-K" program, validating the district's expansion of pre-k across all schools.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report only; no formal vote taken.

[00:31:06 Approval of Consent Agenda

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Leadership.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The consent agenda included minutes from January 25th, donations, fundraising requests, personnel actions, personnel stipends (regarding JD Vance), authority to prepay claims, and claim approval.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

00:31:46 Approval of 2022<U+2013>2023 Board Meeting Dates

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Members.

- **Deliberation Summary:** The board reviewed proposed meeting dates for the 2022<U+2013>2023 cycle. A board member noted a conflict with the scheduled November meeting date falling on election day, expressing concern about interfering with voting or post-work schedules. Following discussion, the board agreed to reschedule the November meeting to November 15th.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (as amended to change the November meeting date to November 15th).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:17:42 Chris Hyatt:** Inquired for the third time regarding the specific medical professionals who formed the basis of the Muncie Community Schools masking policy, requesting they present their credentials or opinions on record. He also expressed frustration with the governing arrangement, characterizing the appointed board as like-minded and hesitant to challenge policies, and called for a board motion to rescind the mask mandate.
 - **00:20:12 Jim Arnold:** Stated he is a concerned citizen, not a terrorist or conspiracy theorist. Citing the Indiana Access to Public Records Act, he formally requested copies of all documentation regarding MCS ongoing diversity, sensitivity, and implicit bias training for the 2020-21 and 2021-22 school years, as well as monthly board reporting documents. He also raised concerns regarding masks, citing perceived negative impacts on child development and learning.
 - **00:23:26 Miss Lee Duke:** Read excerpts from an article by an Oxford University epidemiologist regarding mask use among children, discussing scientific debates surrounding droplet transmission, rebreathing carbon dioxide, potential oxygen deprivation effects, and social/psychological impacts. She urged the board to weigh the harms versus benefits of masks.
 - **00:28:07 Mr. Smackins:** Inquired about the Memorandum of Understanding (MOU) between the school district and the YMCA regarding real estate property. He requested documentation of a conflict of interest review overseen by legal counsel regarding the agreement and expressed concerns about the transfer of public property. Board members and legal counsel clarified that the MOU represents a statement of intent/desire and that precise parameters, consideration, and taxpayer protections will be established when fundraising goals are closer to completion.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Summer programming has over 100 students enrolled, with a comprehensive summer learning and professional development list scheduled for presentation at

the March meeting.

- Brad (Administration) provided an update on repairs at the field house, noting that the vendor is actively working in inclement weather to secure bricks using retention screws.
- Shouted out Muncie Central wrestlers advancing to semi-state, noting a send-off bus departure scheduled for Friday at 5:30 PM.
- A board member shared positive anecdotal feedback from a community member whose student transferred to Muncie Central and experienced significant academic and personal growth.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially concluded with a motion to adjourn.
 - **Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

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